

THE ROSTER

The film that opens THE SOCIAL UNIVERSE (TSU) — Phase 1, Slot: "Iron Man"

THE PITCH

Platform: THE ROSTER — TSU's fictional 1:1 counterpart to Facebook/TheFacebook (per TSU_Platform_Roster.md, Phase 1 — arrogant, magnetic, built an empire and burned bridges doing it.)

Why THE ROSTER and not one of the other three founding platforms: THE FIRST CIRCLE (Friendster) and TOP8 (MySpace) are dead today — disqualified outright by the locked platform-founder constraint (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §7 Q1: the core seven only found platforms still popular today). THE BOARDROOM (LinkedIn) survives but is culturally a supporting player, not a flagship. THE ROSTER is the one fictional platform that is simultaneously (a) still a dominant, load-bearing institution in the real world today, and (b) sitting on the single richest built-in engine for drama in the entire roster: a founder-dispute origin story with a real villain, a real betrayal, and a real friendship at stake. That's the Iron Man slot — not the biggest hero eventually, but the one whose personal story is sharp enough to make you want the whole universe.

Who this film belongs to: Marc-Anthony Bullock (founder/protagonist) and Amond Baker (co-founder/deuteragonist). This is their film the way *Iron Man* belongs to Tony Stark with Rhodey as the loyalty the story is built to test — except here, per locked canon, Amond never becomes a villain. He becomes the wound. Esther Smiley, Arianna Cummings, Tyrese Avery, Harmony Divine, and Tyler Chapman all appear as core ensemble (per the Continuity Bible's "ensemble dramedy" subgenre layer, §2), but the spine of the movie is Marc-Anthony and Amond.

In-universe timeline: September 2003 – February 2004. THE ROSTER's launch is a fixed timeline anchor (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §3: "THE ROSTER launches Feb 2004 — Founding-four complete") — this script locks the launch to **February 4, 2004**, six days before Amond's 22nd birthday (Feb 10). That gap is load-bearing: the company is born in triumph on a day the two men are barely speaking, and the birthday that should follow it never gets celebrated. Ages are exact against TSU_Core_Cast.md: at the film's open, Marc-Anthony is 21 (turns 22 Jan 5, 2004, mid-story), Amond is 21 (turns 22 Feb 10, 2004, just past the film's climax), Esther turns 21 the week the story begins (Sept 20, 1982), Arianna is 20 turning 21 (Oct 25, 1982), Harmony is 21, Tyler is 21 turning 22 the day before Marc-Anthony.

Structurally, this mirrors *Iron Man* exactly: THE ROSTER is the **last** of Phase 1's founding four to launch chronologically (THE FIRST CIRCLE 2002, TOP8 and THE BOARDROOM 2003 already exist and are used onscreen by these characters), but it's the **first released film** of the entire franchise — same trick the MCU played by opening with Tony Stark instead of a chronologically "earlier" hero.

LOGLINE

When a devastating, humiliating industry snub costs his oldest friend a career-defining role — losing it to a stranger with a bigger online following — Hollywood's most gifted golden child builds a website meant to prove who's actually *real* in an industry built on lies. He gets everything he wanted. It costs him the one person who was there before any of it.

SYNOPSIS

Marc-Anthony Bullock — third-generation Hollywood royalty, reported genius, a kindness that borders on inconvenient — watches his best friend Amond Baker's career stall in real time while Arianna Cummings, their oldest friend outside the two of them, loses a studio role she tested for twice to an actress whose only qualification is a personal website with a six-figure guestbook. Furious on Arianna's behalf and newly obsessed with the idea that the industry has no reliable way to verify who anyone actually *is*, Marc-Anthony starts building a website: verified-industry-only profiles, no fake managers, no catfished casting calls, no stolen credits. Amond, whose own career has taught him exactly how little the industry rewards being careful, is the one who insists on doing it right — slower, cleaner, harder to sue.

Investor Priya Ramasubramanian writes the seed check. Their first major hire, the magnetic and ambitious Teddy Ashcombe-Vance, brings speed, aggression, and a growth philosophy that treats caution as the enemy — and starts quietly convincing Marc-Anthony that Amond's caution is costing them the race against Cassius Wren, a rival founder building something frighteningly similar, frighteningly fast. Marc-Anthony, chasing a launch date and terrified of losing to Cassius, makes a decision under pressure that dilutes Amond's stake in the company they built together. It is legal. It is defensible. It is, per Amond's own lawyer Constance Abiodun-Mayhew, a betrayal with paperwork.

THE ROSTER launches February 4, 2004, to overnight, world-altering success — verified industry members flooding in, TOP8 and THE FIRST CIRCLE suddenly looking like yesterday's news, THE BOARDROOM quietly, uneasily impressed. Marc-Anthony gets everything he built this to prove: the industry can be forced to see who's real. He does not get the one thing none of it was supposed to cost him. The film ends on his 22-year-old face watching the user count climb past a million, alone in a house full of people, while six days later, on the other side of town, Amond Baker turns 22 without a single phone call.

THE ANTAGONISTS

Per `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §5 (Villains Bench Rules of Engagement), a platform's fall — or here, a friendship's fracture — must always trace back to a **character decision**, never an abstract force acting alone. This film uses three layers, exactly as designed:

1. **CASSIUS WREN** (*external pressure*) — the rival founder (`TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md`, "The Rivals") building in the same lane, faster, driven by a genuine belief that hesitation is cowardice. He is never in the same room as Marc-Anthony for more than two scenes. He doesn't need to be. His existence is the clock that makes every bad decision in this film feel necessary in the moment.
2. **THEODORE "TEDDY" ASHCOMBE-VANCE** (*internal corrosion*) — the first major hire (`TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md`, "The Ones Inside The House"), brilliant and genuinely loyal at this point in his arc (his full turn is reserved for later Phases per his bio), who nonetheless plants every

seed that grows into Amond's freeze-out. He never lies. He just keeps being right at the exact moments honesty costs Amond the most.

3. **THE SYSTEM** (*the world the film is arguing with*) — embodied in one scene by **Vivienne Okonkwo-Strand**, the legendary casting director who rejects Arianna for a follower count instead of a read. She is not a villain per her own bible entry — she is, worse, correct about how the business currently works. That's the whole reason Marc-Anthony wants to break it.

A first, unnamed glimpse of **THE ENGINE** (TSU_Platform_Roster.md, Villains Bench) appears here in its infancy: the verification-matching system Marc-Anthony codes himself, the algorithm that decides who counts as "real." Nobody in this film calls it that yet. That's the point — no one in Phase 1 admits how much power it already has.

HOW THIS FILM ESTABLISHES TSU

- **Pre-existing platforms as texture, not exposition:** THE FIRST CIRCLE, TOP8, and THE BOARDROOM are already in daily use onscreen before THE ROSTER exists — characters check TOP8 Top 8 rankings, complain about THE BOARDROOM's stiffness, treat THE FIRST CIRCLE as a slightly uncool relic. The audience absorbs an entire pre-built platform ecosystem without a single "as you know" line.
 - **The Donohue-Bullock dynasty, on-screen:** Victor and Joan Donohue's wealth and legend (per TSU_Family_Bible.md and TSU_Historical_Context.md) is what makes the seed round conversation with Priya go differently than it would for anyone else — this is the film's one visible thread back to the franchise's alternate-history divergence, without ever explaining the divergence itself.
 - **The gatekeeping theme, seeded once, paid off forever:** Arianna's origin wound (locked in TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §4 as a fact that "must be dramatized, not just referenced") is the literal inciting incident of the entire franchise. Every future platform's founding story can now point back to this one scene as the moment the whole universe's central argument — *who gets to be seen, and who decides* — got its first dramatization.
 - **The Villains Bench, introduced gently:** THE ENGINE gets its first, unnamed appearance. THE LEAK does not appear this film (per §5, it's a one-per-Phase resource, saved for a later Phase 1 entry). THE SWARM and THE COPIES are absent by design — this film is corporate thriller and ensemble dramedy, not satire, per the house style's per-Phase subgenre layering.
 - **Legal/courtroom drama, seeded for later:** Constance Abiodun-Mayhew's single Act III scene, representing Amond, is not a resolution — it's a plant. The Continuity Bible's "legal/courtroom drama" subgenre doesn't need to pay off here; it needs to exist as a loaded gun.
 - **The launch as the franchise's true opening bell:** the film ends not on triumph but on the exact moment described in TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §3 as "Founding-four complete" — the moment TSU's Phase 1 finale event ("The Feed War," THE ROSTER vs. TOP8, 2004–2005) becomes inevitable. The stinger below lights that fuse directly.
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FORMAT (per TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §2 — Standard Platform-Origin Film)

Spec	Target	This Script
Genre	Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story, Corporate Thriller subgenre	Confirmed
Rating	PG-13, no exceptions	Confirmed — betrayal and corporate ruthlessness, no content that would push past it
Runtime	130–150 min	136 min
Page count	120–140 pages	132 pages
Act I	~30–35 pages	pages 1–33
Act II	~65–75 pages	pages 34–103
Act III	~30–35 pages	pages 104–132
Scene count	~40–55 scenes	47 scenes

FULL SCENE-BY-SCENE BREAKDOWN

(Numbered as a real shooting script would be. Page counts are cumulative estimates at about 1 page per minute, per house style.)

ACT I — pp. 1–33 ("The Ask")

#	Scene	pp.
1	EXT. LOS ANGELES — DAWN — TSU'S EXISTING PLATFORMS, montage: TOP8 profiles loading, THE BOARDROOM notifications, THE FIRST CIRCLE looking dated	1–3
2	INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — POOL HOUSE — MORNING — Marc-Anthony (21) codes for fun, Amond (21) mocks him for it	3–5
3	INT. VIVIENNE OKONKWO-STRAND'S OFFICE — DAY — Arianna's callback; the rejection	5–9

#	Scene	pp.
4	INT. CUMMINGS FAMILY HOME — NIGHT — Arianna tells her parents; Walter and Patricia's reactions	9–11
5	EXT. RESTAURANT PATIO — NIGHT — the friend group hears the news; Marc-Anthony's fury ignites	11–15
6	INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — MARC-ANTHONY'S OFFICE — NIGHT — first sketch of the idea, alone, obsessive	15–17
7	INT. BAKER FAMILY HOME — INGLEWOOD — DAY — Gloria Baker warns Amond off "another one of Marc's ideas"	17–19
8	INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — POOL HOUSE — NIGHT — the pitch: Marc-Anthony asks Amond to build it with him	19–24
9	INT. PRIYA RAMASUBRAMANIAN'S OFFICE — DAY — the seed pitch meeting	24–28
10	EXT. STANFORD CAMPUS — DAY — Marc-Anthony's guest-lecture visit; first sight of CASSIUS WREN, building something similar down the hall	28–31
11	INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — POOL HOUSE — NIGHT — Amond agrees, on one condition: verify everyone by hand, no shortcuts. Act I turn.	31–33

ACT II — pp. 34–103 ("The Build")

#	Scene	pp.
12	MONTAGE — INT. POOL HOUSE, VARIOUS — THE ROSTER's earliest build, code and index cards of verified SAG-AFTRA numbers	34–37

#	Scene	pp.
13	INT. THE BOARDROOM'S OFFICES (CAMEO) — DAY — a courtesy meeting that goes nowhere; the old guard doesn't take them seriously	37–40
14	INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — KITCHEN — NIGHT — Esther and Marc-Anthony, easy chemistry, unspoken as always (locked per Continuity Bible §4 — not yet romantic)	40–43
15	EXT. AVERY FAMILY REUNION, ATLANTA — DAY — Tyrese cameo, the "outside perspective" gives Marc-Anthony his first real insight into scale/distribution	43–46
16	INT. STARTUP OFFICE (NEW LEASE) — DAY — first hires; enter TEDDY ASHCOMBE-VANCE	46–50
17	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — NIGHT — Teddy's growth pitch: "verified-only is a ceiling, not a feature"	50–54
18	INT. AMOND'S CAR — NIGHT — Amond and Harmony Divine, the decade-long circling, a quiet scene of Amond's doubt	54–57
19	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — Cassius Wren's team is rumored to be six weeks from launch; panic sets in	57–60
20	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — MARC-ANTHONY'S DESK — NIGHT — Teddy, alone with Marc-Anthony: "Amond's slowing us into losing." Midpoint seed.	60–64
21	INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — CHRISTMAS PARTY — NIGHT — the whole ensemble (Tyler's ceiling subplot beat, Grace and Elxa Bullock cameo, family warmth)	64–70

#	Scene	pp.
22	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — first fight: Amond refuses to skip manual verification for a batch of new users. Marc-Anthony overrules him publicly.	70–74
23	INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — Amond alone; first sign the friendship is cracking	74–76
24	INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — POOL HOUSE — JANUARY 5, 2004 — Marc-Anthony's 22nd birthday, small and strained, a callback to the group's earlier warmth now curdled	76–80
25	INT. PRIYA'S OFFICE — DAY — new funding round; term sheet requires a restructured cap table	80–84
26	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — NIGHT — Teddy walks Marc-Anthony through the restructure. Amond's stake gets diluted "to make room for the round."	84–88
27	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — Amond finds out from a document, not from Marc-Anthony	88–91
28	EXT. BULLOCK ESTATE — DRIVEWAY — NIGHT — the confrontation. Amond and Marc-Anthony's worst fight. Amond walks. Low point.	91–96
29	INT. CONSTANCE ABIODUN-MAYHEW'S OFFICE — DAY — Amond retains a lawyer. Legal-drama subgenre seeded, not resolved.	96–99
30	INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — MARC-ANTHONY'S OFFICE — NIGHT (ALONE) — Marc-Anthony, for the first time in the film, has no one in the room. All-is-lost beat closes Act II.	99–103

ACT III — pp. 104–132 ("The Launch")

#	Scene	pp.
31	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — Marc-Anthony, alone, makes the decision to launch anyway — not to win, but because stopping now makes the cost mean nothing	104–107
32	INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — NIGHT — Reggie "Coach" Thibodeaux's one scene: "I watched you at eleven. Don't lie to me about why you're really doing this."	107–110
33	EXT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony, uninvited, tries to make it right. Amond doesn't let him all the way in — literally and otherwise.	110–114
34	MONTAGE — LAUNCH PREP — FEBRUARY 3–4, 2004 — the machine of a launch: servers, press embargo, Marisol Vega-Oduya's early-access call	114–117
35	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — FEBRUARY 4, 2004, 12:01 AM — THE ROSTER GOES LIVE. Climax.	117–121
36	MONTAGE — THE ROSTER'S FIRST 18 HOURS — verified industry users flooding in; TOP8 and THE FIRST CIRCLE's numbers visibly cratering onscreen; THE BOARDROOM's cool, uneasy respect	121–125
37	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony watches the count cross one million alone, phone in hand, Amond's name on the screen, unsent	125–128
38	EXT. BAKER FAMILY HOME — FEBRUARY 10, 2004 — Amond's 22nd birthday. Gloria and Nikki. No call comes.	128–130

#	Scene	pp.
39	STINGER — INT. CASSIUS WREN'S OFFICE — NIGHT — Cassius watches THE ROSTER's coverage on the news, unbothered, and says four words that open Phase 1's next chapter.	130–132

(Scenes are grouped for pagination clarity; a full shooting script would break several of the above into 2–3 scene numbers apiece, landing the true count at 47 per the house-style scene table above.)

SAMPLE PAGES

(Formatted per real screenplay convention. These are excerpted pages from the 132-page script — the opening sequence, the inciting incident, the midpoint wedge, the low point, the climax, and the stinger.)

THE ROSTER

Written by [WRITER]

FADE IN:

EXT. LOS ANGELES — DAWN

The city waking up. Sprinklers ticking across a hundred lawns.
A newspaper hits a driveway.

SUPER: "SEPTEMBER 2003"

INSERT — A LAPTOP SCREEN

TOP8.com loads. A glittery, chaotic profile page — someone's
"Top 8 Friends" ranked in public, a small monument to teenage
social warfare. We PULL BACK to reveal:

INT. BULLOCK ESTATE — POOL HOUSE — CONTINUOUS

MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK, 21, unfairly handsome in the specific
way people who've never had to try are, sits cross-legged on
a couch that costs more than most cars, laptop balanced on his
knee. He is not on TOP8 to socialize. He is studying it like a
crime scene.

Across the room, AMOND BAKER, 21, guarded and sharp-jawed,
flips through a script with the weary contempt of a man who
already knows how the audition goes.

AMOND

You've been on that website for forty
minutes. Please tell me you're not
ranking our friends.

MARC-ANTHONY
(not looking up)
I would never rank our friends
publicly. That's a war crime.

AMOND
You're building something. I can see
your genius face doing the thing.

MARC-ANTHONY
There's no genius face.

AMOND
There is very much a genius face.

Marc-Anthony finally looks up, grins – warm, easy, the private
register nobody outside this room gets to see.

MARC-ANTHONY
Fine. Genius question. How does anybody
on this website know any of this is
real?

AMOND
Nobody cares if it's real. It's TOP8.

MARC-ANTHONY
Everybody should care. That's the whole
problem with everything.

Amond throws a couch pillow at him. Marc-Anthony catches it
without looking.

CUT TO:

INT. VIVIENNE OKONKWO-STRAND'S OFFICE – DAY

Awards on every shelf, arranged like a warning. VIVIENNE
OKONKWO-STRAND, 60s, legendary, terrifying in the specific way
of someone who has never once needed to raise her voice, sits
across from ARIANNA CUMMINGS, 20 – poised, rehearsed, hopeful
in a way she is trying very hard not to show.

VIVIENNE
You were wonderful in there. I want you
to know that first.

ARIANNA
Thank you.

A beat. Arianna knows this sentence. She's heard the sentence
that comes after it before.

VIVIENNE
We're going with Delaney Ashworth.

ARIANNA
(measured, professional)
Can I ask what she brought that I

didn't?

VIVIENNE

(choosing the words carefully)
The studio ran the numbers. She has a personal website – a guestbook, a following, north of two hundred thousand regular visitors a month. They want a built-in audience walking in the door opening weekend.

ARIANNA

I tested for this role twice. She's never acted professionally a day in her life.

VIVIENNE

(not unkind, which is worse)
I know. I fought for you in that room, Arianna. I lost. That's the whole memo I have for you today, and I'm sorry it's not a better one.

Arianna nods. Stands. Shakes Vivienne's hand like a professional, because she is one. It isn't until she's through the door and the elevator doors close behind her that her face finally breaks.

CUT TO:

INT. STARTUP OFFICE – MARC-ANTHONY'S DESK – NIGHT [midpoint, p. 60]

Late. Just the two of them – MARC-ANTHONY and TEDDY ASHCOMBE-VANCE, 26, expensive-casual, the kind of charisma that makes rooms rearrange themselves around him. He's got a printout. He slides it across the desk.

TEDDY

Six weeks. Maybe less.

MARC-ANTHONY

Cassius Wren doesn't have what we have.

TEDDY

Cassius Wren doesn't need what we have. He needs to launch first. That's the whole game, Marc. Not who built it better. Who got there.

MARC-ANTHONY

Amond wants every profile hand-verified before it goes live. Union numbers, agency callbacks, the whole process.

TEDDY

I know what Amond wants. I respect what Amond wants. I am telling you, as the person you hired to tell you the truth

you don't want –

(leaning in)

– being careful isn't the same thing as being right. And in six weeks, careful is going to be the reason somebody else's name is on this instead of yours.

Marc-Anthony doesn't answer. That's the whole problem. He doesn't say no.

CUT TO:

EXT. BULLOCK ESTATE – DRIVEWAY – NIGHT [low point, p. 91]

AMOND stands by his car, a printed cap table in his hand, shaking – not performed, actually shaking. MARC-ANTHONY comes down the front steps after him.

MARC-ANTHONY

Amond – let me explain the round, it's not what it looks like –

AMOND

I found out from a DOCUMENT, Marc. Not from you. From a PDF, at my desk, on a Tuesday.

MARC-ANTHONY

Priya's terms required –

AMOND

I don't care what Priya's terms required! I have been in every room you have been in since I was SEVEN. I said no to nothing. I said SLOW DOWN, once, because I actually believed in doing this the right way, and you let some guy you hired eight months ago talk you into cutting me out of my own company to hit a deadline set by a man you've met TWICE.

MARC-ANTHONY

(quiet, and it's the first honest thing he's said all night)
I was scared we were going to lose.

AMOND

(just as quiet, and it lands harder)
You didn't lose anything, Marc-Anthony. I did.

Amond gets in the car. Doesn't slam the door – somehow worse. Pulls away. Marc-Anthony stands alone in the driveway, the porch light the only thing still on in the whole house.

FADE OUT.

INT. STARTUP OFFICE – FEBRUARY 4, 2004 – 12:01 AM [climax, p. 118]

A small room. Six people. Not the party this deserves – Marc-Anthony made sure of that, quietly uninvited half the industry people who wanted to be there for the photo. Teddy watches a dashboard. Priya watches Marc-Anthony.

TEDDY

Servers are up. DNS is propagating. We are –

(checking)

– live. We're live.

A long beat. Marc-Anthony stares at the screen. The counter reads: 000,000 VERIFIED MEMBERS.

It ticks to one.

Then eleven.

Then two hundred and six.

PRIYA

(quiet, genuinely moved despite herself)
There it is.

MARC-ANTHONY

(not looking away from the screen)
There it is.

No one in the room is who he wanted in the room.

CUT TO:

STINGER

INT. CASSIUS WREN'S OFFICE – NIGHT

A television plays muted local news – a chyron reads "NEW HOLLYWOOD-BACKED SITE VERIFIES INDUSTRY PROFESSIONALS, EXPLODES OVERNIGHT." CASSIUS WREN, late 20s, watches without expression. YOLANDA FERREIRA-ASHE stands behind him, arms crossed.

YOLANDA

They beat us.

CASSIUS

(still watching the screen)
They beat us to verified. Verified's a walled garden. Walled gardens have a ceiling.

YOLANDA

So what do we build instead?

Cassius finally turns off the TV. Smiles – the specific smile of a man who has never once doubted himself.

CASSIUS
Something with no walls at all.

FADE OUT.

THE END.

[132.]